



Titles and Forms of Address

INTRODUCTION

It is sometimes difficult to know how to address clergy of the various member churches. In the WCC database, File Maker Pro (FMP), titles and salutation fields are available in working languages of the WCC as appropriate. Any correspondence to the head of a member church should only be sent under signature of the general secretary.

First edition 1987, revised in 1995, 1999, 2012.

NOTES

“The Rev.” or “Rev.” should never be used with the surname (last name) only. The first name or initial(s) must always be given, or, if these are not known, Mr or Dr should be inserted.

e.g. The* Rev. John Smith or Rev. J. Smith or Rev. Mr Smith
 but NOT The Rev. Smith

In common usage “The” is often omitted.

Rev. and Revd are alternative forms; in the Council we tend to use “Rev.”, while the latter is more current in the UK.

Letters should begin: Dear Mr Smith, NEVER Dear Rev. Smith.

Doctorates/professorships: In British usage, if a priest/ minister has a doctorate, both titles are used on the envelope: e.g. The Rev. Dr (or Rev. Prof.) Mary Smith. The letter should begin: Dear Dr Smith.

Wives of clergy do not have any special form of address: simply Mrs Mary Smith; less current now: Rev. and Mrs John Smith.

(For leaders and clergy of other faiths, consult the WCC Inter-Religious Dialogue and Cooperation)

CHURCH FAMILIES

I. Anglicans

A. Church of England and associated churches in the Anglican Communion

Archbishops

The Most Rev. the Archbishop of Blank Dear Archbishop
or

The Most Rev. Peter Jones, (Archbishop of Blank) Dear Archbishop

Retired Archbishops

On retirement, Archbishops revert to the Dear Bishop Jones
status of a Bishop:

The Rt Rev. Peter Jones

Diocesan and Suffragan Bishops

The Rt Rev. the Bishop of Blank Dear Bishop
or

The Rt Rev. Peter Jones Dear Bishop

Assistant and retired Bishops

The Rt Rev. Peter Jones Dear Bishop Jones

Deans

The Very Rev. the Dean of Blank Dear Dean
or

The Very Rev. Peter Jones Dear Dean

Provosts

The Very Rev. the Provost of Blank Dear Provost
or

The Very Rev. Peter Jones Dear Provost

Archdeacons

The Venerable the Archdeacon of Blank Dear Archdeacon
or

The Ven. Peter Jones Dear Archdeacon

Canons

The Rev. Canon Peter Jones Dear Canon Jones

Prebenderies

The Rev. Prebendary Peter Jones Dear Prebendary Jones

Other Anglican clergy

The Rev. John Smith Dear Mr Smith, or, if he prefers,

The Rev. Mary Smith

Dear Father Smith
Dear Ms, Miss or Mrs Smith

B. Episcopal Church USA (and churches associated with it, e.g. in Brazil, Japan.)

NB: The Primate is not an Archbishop but the Presiding Bishop

Presiding Bishop

The Most Rev. Edmond Browning

Dear Bishop Browning

Other Bishops

The Rt Rev. Peter Jones, Bishop of Blank
or

Dear Bishop Jones

Bishop Peter Jones of Blank

Dear Bishop Jones

Other clergy

(see under Church of England)

C. Episcopal Church in Scotland

NB: The Primate is the Primus of Scotland

Primus

Dear Primus

The Most Rev. the Primus

Bishops

Dear Bishop

The Rt Rev. John Smith, Bishop of Blank

Other clergy

(see under Church of England)

II. Baptistis

Ministers

The Rev. John Smith
The Rev. Mary Jones

Dear Mr Smith
Dear Ms, Miss or Mrs Jones

III. Reformed

A. Church of Scotland

Moderator

(The) Rt Rev. John Smith

Dear Moderator or Dear Mr

(The) Moderator of the Church of Scotland	Smith
Former Moderator (The) Very Rev. John Smith	Dear Mr Smith
Ministers The Rev. John/Mary Smith	Dear Mr/Ms, etc. Smith

B. United Reformed Church in the UK

Moderator The Rt Rev. John Smith	Dear Moderator
Former Moderators revert to (The) Rev.	
Ministers (as for the Church of Scotland)	

C. Presbyterian Church of Wales

Moderator The Rev. John Smith	Dear Moderator
Ministers (as for the Church of Scotland)	

D. Presbyterian and Reformed churches in the USA

All clergy, ordained moderators, former moderators or parish pastors The Rev. John/Mary Smith	Dear Moderator or Dear Mr, Ms etc. Smith
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IV. DISCIPLES

As for Baptists and Reformed

V. LUTHERANS

Archbishops The Most Rev. John Smith or The Most Rev. John Smith, Archbishop of Blank	Dear Archbishop Dear Archbishop
Bishops (The) Rt Rev. John Smith	Dear Bishop

or
(The) Rt Rev. John Smith, Bishop of Blank
or
Bishop John Smith

Clergy
(The) Rev. John Smith
(The) Rev. Mary Smith
Pastor John Smith (widely used in the USA)

Dear Mr Smith
Dear Ms, Miss or Mrs Smith
Dear Pastor Smith

VI. Methodist

The Methodist Church UK has no bishop but a President of the Methodist Conference; no special form of address but known as the "President of Conference".

Bishops
Bishop John Smith
or
Rev. Bishop John Smith

Dear Bishop Smith

Dear Bishop Smith

Clergy
(as for the Church of England)

Deaconesses
Deaconess Jane Smith
or
Sister Jane Smith

Dear Sister Jane

Dear Sister Jane

Exception
The Methodist Church Nigeria has a Prelate as head of the church
His Eminence S. Ola Makinde

Your Eminence

VII. MORAVIANS

The term "Brother" (including a bishop) or "Sister" may be used in general correspondence.

Bishops
The Rt Rev. John Smith

Dear Brother or
Dear Bishop Smith

Presbyters and Deacons
The Rev. John/Mary Smith

Dear Brother/Sister
Dear Mr/Ms etc. Smith

VIII. Old Catholics

In general, Old Catholics follow the Anglican pattern.

IX. Religious Society of Friends / Quakers

Quakers use no titles at all.

Anne Mitchell

Dear Val Ferguson

X. SALVATION ARMY

Ranks of Officers (Salvation Army ministers) are:

General Linda Bond

Dear General

Commissioner John Smith

Dear Commissioner

Colonel John Smith or
Lieutenant-Colonel John Smith

Dear Colonel

Major John Smith

Dear Major

Captain John Smith

Dear Captain

Lieutenant John Smith

Dear Lieutenant

XI. UNITED CHURCHES

United Churches use a variety of titles (see FMP). In general, they follow Reformed practice, but often the head of the church is a Bishop rather than a Moderator.

XII. ORTHODOX CHURCHES

Patriarchs

The Ecumenical Patriarch of Constantinople
His All Holiness Bartholomeos,
The Ecumenical Patriarch of Constantinople

Your All Holiness

Patriarchs of the Russian, Bulgarian and Serbian Orthodox Churches
His Holiness Patriarch Kirill I,
Patriarch of Moscow and All Russia

Your Holiness

His Holiness Maxim, Patriarch of Bulgaria	Your Holiness
His Holiness Patriarch Irinej, Serbia	Your Holiness

Patriarchs of the Romanian Orthodox Church, and Greek Orthodox Patriarchates of Alexandria, Antioch and Jerusalem

His Beatitude Daniel, Patriarch of Romania	Your Beatitude
His Beatitude Theodorus II, Pope and Patriarch of Alexandria and All Africa	Your Beatitude
His Beatitude Ignatios IV of Antioch and All the East	Your Beatitude
His Beatitude Theophilus III, Patriarch of Jerusalem	Your Beatitude

Patriarchs of Oriental Orthodox Churches (Coptic Orthodox Church, Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church, Armenian Apostolic Church [Etchmiadzin], Syrian Orthodox Patriarchate of Antioch, Malankara Orthodox Syrian Church, India)

His Holiness Pope Shenouda III (Coptic)	Your Holiness
His Holiness Patriarch Abune Paulos (Ethiopia)	Your Holiness
His Holiness Karekin I, Patriarch-Catholikos of All the Armenians	Your Holiness
His Holiness Ignatius Zakka I, Syrian Orthodox Patriarch of Antioch and All the East	Your Holiness

His Holiness Baselios Marthoma Paulose II Patriarch-Catholikos of the East & Metropolitan of Malankara	Your Holiness
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Metropolitans and Archbishops who are heads of autocephalic churches (Albania, Cyprus, Greece, Poland)

His Beatitude Archbishop Anastasios of Tirana and All Albania	Your Beatitude
His Beatitude Archbishop Chrysostomos II of Cyprus	Your Beatitude
His Beatitude Hieronymos II, Archbishop of Athens and All Greece	Your Beatitude
His Beatitude Metropolitan Sawa of Warsaw and All Poland	Your Beatitude

Heads of other Orthodox Churches

His Beatitude Chrystofor, Archbishop of Prague & Metropolitan of Czech Lands & Slovakia	Your Beatitude
His Holiness Ilia II, Catholicos-Patriarch of All Georgia	Your Holiness
His Eminence Archbishop Nikolaj, Orthodox Church in the Slovak Republic	Your Eminence
His Eminence Archbishop Leo of Karelia and All Finland	Your Eminence

His Holiness Mar Dinkha IV, Catholicos Patriarch Holy Apostolic Catholic Assyrian Church of the East	Your Holiness
His Beatitude Jonah, Metropolitan of All America Orthodox Church in America [USA]	Your Beatitude
His Eminence Daniel, Archbishop of Tokyo & Metropolitan of All Japan Other Metropolitans and Archbishops (Eastern Orthodox)	Your Eminence
His Eminence Metropolitan Teofan Savu of Moldavia and Bukovina (Romanian Orthodox Church)	Your Eminence or Dear Metropolitan
His Eminence Metropolitan Hilarion of Volokolamsk Other Metropolitans and Archbishops (Oriental Orthodox)	Your Eminence or Dear Metropolitan
His Grace Archbishop Nareg Alemezian (Armenian Apostolic Church - Cilicia)	Your Grace or Dear Archbishop
His Eminence Metropolitan Philipos Mar Eusebius, Malankara Orthodox Syrian Church [India]	Your Eminence or Dear Metropolitan
His Grace Archbishop Athanasios of Beni Souef (Coptic Orthodox Church)	Your Grace or Dear Archbishop
Bishops (Eastern and Oriental) His Grace Bishop Ciprian of Campineanul (Romania)	Your Grace Or Dear Bishop
For Patriarchs, Metropolitans, Archbishops and Bishops it is important to include the area they are Patriarch/Metr./ Archbishop/Bishop of: e.g. Bishop John of Thessoloniki	
Archpriests and Archimandrites The Very Rev. Father Mikhail Gundyayev	Dear Father Mikhail
Priests The Rev. Father John Smith	Dear Father John
Deacons The Rev. Deacon John Smith	Dear Deacon

XIII. Roman Catholic Church

Pope

His Holiness John Paul II

Your Holiness

Cardinals

His Eminence Edward, Cardinal Cassidy

Your Eminence

Archbishops

His Excellency John, Archbishop of Blank

Your Excellency

Bishops

His Excellency John, Bishop of Blank

Your Excellency

Monsignor

Monsignor John Smith (Mgr John Smith)

Monsignor

Priests

The Rev. John Smith

Dear Father Smith
or Dear Father John